

61

PER CENT OF LUDHIANA MEN
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garity, subversion and westernisation. Public resistance is strangely marginal and best represented by the recent Pink Chaddi Campaign, a Facebook initiative that challenged a Hindu nationalist organisation in Karnataka which had threatened to force unmarried couples into marriage on Valentine's Day 2009, by practising modern Gandhigiri and sending hundreds of pink underwear to its head office. The second example is that of Prem Kunj, or the Lovers' Park, in Kolkata. Criticising the lack of protected and quiet spaces for couples in public, and referring to the lack of space and recognition of the needs of proper conjugal love in urban environments, The Lover's Organisation for Voluntary Exhibition (L.O.V.E.) has been demanding safe 'erotic zones' since 2000. The downside of this organisation, however, seems to be that it opposes homosexuality, pre-marital sex and Western 'physical-only style'.

This sex survey's particular focus on fantasising places in relation to wanderlust seems involuntarily significant: in the original German, wanderlust refers to the Romantic tradition of a nostalgic yearning, lust/love, for individual and independent movement, travel through, or even away from one's 'heimat', home. Maybe 'non-spaces' such as hotels (27 per cent had sex in a hotel room) or gated condominiums are the best protected spaces for fantasising lovers. But one has to pay a high price for this protected space, financially and symbolically. Moreover, it seems as if the mass media have become another protected space for erotic aspirations, opening up intimate channels for the secret love talk, as in the film *Sujata* (1959) where the impossibility of class and casteless love is manifested, and challenged, when the hero confesses his love to his beloved in a highly erotic phone conversation, or when we consider the rising popularity of SMS love-making in India.

One conclusion of the sex survey with respect to fantasising places could be that it is the property of a privileged elite who can afford to fantasise by the sheer power of lifestyle and class distinction. Within that privileged, affluent segment of Indian society, men seem to have a clearer preference for sex in semi-public places than the women. Does this allow us to allege a greater distrust of public safety by women? On the other hand, the result that the places making up these topographies of erotic life are located mostly in semi-public or private spaces could provoke the question whether these segments have already internalised the disapproving gaze of the bourgeoisie, this restricting their fantasies to 'go-zones' of the imaginary, the private and the media domain.

The thrill of wanderlust is a luxury item. To be consumed by a few. Whether or not we should declare that it something to be consumed by all alike is not to be decided here. Certainly, the opening up of the public space is worthwhile being fantasised and fought for.

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